

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Zambia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that! You're at a very important crossroads, and it's great that you're already thinking ahead. Since you're in Denmark, have just finished **primary school** (folkeskolen), and are around **16 years old**, your next step typically involves **choosing a youth education program (ungdomsuddannelse)**.

Here's a breakdown of your main options, based on your background and what might fit different interests:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

If you're interested in university later on, these are strong academic pathways.

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broad, academic. Good if you enjoy a mix of subjects like history, science, languages.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)** – Focuses on business, economics, and international trade. Great if you're interested in business or working internationally (especially interesting with your multicultural background).
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)** – Focuses on technology, science, and innovation. Great for future engineers, IT, or science careers.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – A 2-year program (compared to the 3-year STX/HHX/HTX) for students who may want a more direct route to higher education or weren't keen on school earlier but are now motivated.

✓ **Best if:** You like school, want to keep your options open, and possibly attend university later.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

These are more hands-on programs where you combine school with practical work experience.

You can train to become:

- Electrician
- Carpenter
- Mechanic
- Health care assistant
- IT-supporter

- Chef
- ...and many more.

✓ **Best if:** You want to get a job sooner, prefer learning by doing, or know you want to work in a specific trade or service.

Considering Your Background

Being bilingual and having a multicultural background is a **big strength** in Denmark – especially in international business, social work, healthcare, teaching, and IT.

Some ideas:

- **HHX** if you're into economics, marketing, or business (your background could give you an edge in global thinking).
 - **HTX** if you like tech or science (very future-oriented).
 - **HF** if you're not sure yet, but still want access to higher education later.
 - **EUX** – Combines vocational training **and** a high school diploma, so you get the best of both worlds.
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What To Do Now

1. **Think about what you enjoy** – Do you like working with people, numbers, tech, hands-on tasks?
 2. **Visit educational fairs or guidance counselors (studievejleder)** – Most Danish schools offer good help.
 3. **Talk to others** – Teachers, family, friends, older students.
 4. **Try intro courses (brobygning)** – You can often try different education types for a week or two.
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Would you like help thinking through your interests and strengths to narrow this down? I can ask you a few questions to help find the best match.